

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Common Good and Community - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Common Good and Community

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Topic Stakes, Concept Map and Essential Definitions

2 Gauba's Common-Good Argument

3 Common Good, Common Interest, Public Interest and Consensus

4 The Liberal Route and Macpherson's Correction

5 Communitarian Embeddedness and Thinker-Specific Mechanisms

6 The Marxian Class Barrier

7 Gandhian Trusteeship, Bread Labour and Sarvodaya

8 Comparison, Trap Repair and Revision Spine

9 Directive Control, Reconstructions and Objection-Reply Chains

10 Plurality, Indian Applications, MCQ Ledger and PYQ Routes

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Common Good and Community - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A claimant shifts between state advantage, public rhetoric and sectional gain. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- C. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Common-good norm** with **the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

A proposal is defended because it serves the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- B. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- C. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Common-good norm** with **the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Several affected groups want the same immediate outcome, but no wider moral standard has yet been shown. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- C. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Common-interest overlap** with **an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Residents, traders and commuters all support reopening a road because each gains directly from it. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- C. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.
- D. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Common-interest overlap** with **an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

A public authority justifies a regulation in collective terms, yet the wider common-good test still remains open. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- B. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- C. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Public-interest judgment** with **a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

A ministry defends a quarantine order as a public decision responsive to social need. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- C. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Public-interest judgment** with **a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

An answer wrongly treats consensus as the disappearance of disagreement. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- C. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.
- D. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Consensus process** with **continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Groups keep negotiating and adjusting claims under continuing disagreement. Which account applies most directly?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- C. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Consensus process** with **continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

A constitution is judged by whether it serves the whole community's good life rather than one class. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Aristotelian whole** with **a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

A thinker evaluates constitutions by asking whether they advance the good of the whole political community. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- B. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Aristotelian whole** with **a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

A candidate confuses a public-regarding will with the sum of private preferences. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rousseauian general will** with **a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

A theory says common good requires a will directed to the public rather than a mere addition of private wills. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- C. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.
- D. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rousseauian general will** with **a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Political allegiance is tied to a common good of self-development rather than to bare command. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- B. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Greenian obligation** with **political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

A law is treated as morally binding only insofar as it helps sustain a shared good of moral development. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Greenian obligation** with **political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Common good is derived from reconciling claims under civil rules while protecting persons from oppression. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal reconciliation** with **civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

A society relies on rights, lawful adjustment and negotiated coexistence rather than prior moral unity. Which account applies most directly?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal reconciliation** with **civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

A learner treats market reward as an adequate measure of social worth. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.
- B. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Macpherson's correction** with **market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

A theorist argues that demand and supply may undervalue socially necessary human capacities and therefore need welfare correction. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Macpherson's correction** with **market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

The self is presented as socially formed through memberships and shared practices rather than as a detached chooser. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Communitarian embeddedness** with **shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

An argument says people partly discover their goods within communities, practices and social roles. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Communitarian embeddedness** with **shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

A communitarian answer needs the specific mechanism of traditions, internal goods and virtues. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties.
- B. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacIntyrean practices** with **traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

A thinker explains moral formation through cooperative practices sustained by traditions and standards of excellence. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties.
- C. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacIntyrean practices** with **traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

A student wrongly assumes one metric such as money should govern all distributions. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries.
- D. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Walzerian spheres** with **different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Education, office and health are treated as goods with different social meanings. Which account applies most directly?

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Walzerian spheres** with **different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

An answer claims class society can already realise a genuine common good. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian class barrier** with **antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

A theory argues that antagonistic class relations block a truly shared social good until class domination is overcome. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- B. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian class barrier** with **antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

A learner mistakes Gandhi for violent levelling or confiscation. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian trusteeship** with **wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Wealth-holders are told to treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.
- D. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian trusteeship** with **wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Consumption is tied to physical work, dignity and restraint rather than detached privilege. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.
- B. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- C. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- D. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Bread labour** with **Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

A conception of equality asks everyone to perform bodily labour sufficient to justify consumption and honour work. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.
- C. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- D. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Bread labour** with **Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

A candidate reduces Gandhian common good to aggregate pleasure. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. Gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent moral order.
- D. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sarvodaya** with **Gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent moral order**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

A moral-political ideal seeks uplift of all through non-violence, service and transformation rather than aggregate arithmetic. Which account applies most directly?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent moral order.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sarvodaya** with **Gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent moral order**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

A government's institutional strengthening is treated as proof of common good. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- C. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State-good error** with **what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

A measure expands state capacity, but may still injure citizens or the wider community. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- B. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- C. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State-good error** with **what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Numerical support is taken as sufficient moral justification. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- C. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Majority-good error** with **a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

A dominant bloc says its preferred outcome must be common good simply because it commands more votes. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- C. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.
- D. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Majority-good error** with **a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

A minority's suffering is defended as acceptable because overall happiness rises. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- B. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- C. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Utilitarian-aggregate error** with **aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

A policy sacrifices a smaller group while claiming the total sum of benefit justifies the result. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- C. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Utilitarian-aggregate error** with **aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

An agreement satisfies the visible negotiating parties but shifts cost to absent consumers or displaced groups. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- C. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.
- D. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Excluded-public bargain** with **an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Employers and labour settle their dispute, yet the wider public bears the hidden burden. Which account applies most directly?

- A. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- B. a numerical majority cannot convert injustice to minorities into common good.
- C. aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Excluded-public bargain** with **an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

A market order coordinates claims but leaves socially necessary, weakly paid capacities undervalued. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.
- B. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.
- C. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.
- D. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal market weakness** with **market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Prices reward some activities richly while indispensable social functions remain poorly remunerated. Which source-grounded account offers the most precise diagnosis?

- A. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.
- B. market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.
- C. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.
- D. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberal market weakness** with **market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

An answer praises community and duty but does not explain how accountable institutions will resolve conflict. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.
- B. traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties.
- C. moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict.
- D. different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Communitarian machinery weakness** with **moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

A theory offers moral richness and solidarity, yet leaves unclear how disagreements will be settled without domination. Which statement best identifies the mechanism at work?

- A. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.
- B. traditions and cooperative practices generate internal goods, virtues and duties.
- C. different social goods require different distributive meanings and boundaries.
- D. moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Communitarian machinery weakness** with **moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Abolition of private class power is treated as if it automatically guarantees freedom from domination. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- B. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian realisation weakness** with **abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

A revolutionary project removes one structure of class rule but is followed by new concentration of political power. Which interpretation resolves this close distinction?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. Gandhian principle that everyone should perform physical labour sufficient to justify consumption and to uphold equality and dignity of work.

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian realisation weakness** with **abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

An answer assumes trusteeship and renunciation will be supplied by moral persuasion alone. Which source-grounded account best explains the case?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion.
- D. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian voluntarism weakness** with **trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

A programme for common good depends heavily on sustained change of heart by the powerful rather than on enforceable guarantees. Which account applies most directly?

- A. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- B. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- C. wealth-holders should treat surplus property as a moral trust for social welfare.
- D. trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion.

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gandhian voluntarism weakness** with **trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owners are Forms of Government, Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism, Development and Social Progress, Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Forms of Government.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: What is meant by liberal democracy? Does it require deeper principles for social cohesion to balance its own strong affirmation of individual rights? Give reasons from the Indian context.

Model solution

Thesis. Liberal democracy is popular rule placed under CONSTITUTIONAL LIMITS -- rights, rule of law, judicial review and minority protection -- so that the majority governs WITHOUT converting number into unrestricted power; and yes, its strong affirmation of individual rights does require deeper cohesive principles, because formal political equality does not by itself secure the social solidarity a rights-based order presupposes.

- **What it means.** Liberal democracy = democracy (equal authorisation, accountable government) PLUS liberal constitutionalism (entrenched rights, independent courts, limits on majorities). Its defining ideal is that the majority rules but may not extinguish the equal standing of the minority.

- **Why deeper principles are needed.** A purely rights-affirming liberalism can leave citizens as isolated bearers of claims; without fraternity, mutual recognition and substantive equality, formal rights can coexist with real social division. The point is not to dilute rights but to give them a social floor.

- **Indian reasons.** Ambedkar's warning is exactly this: POLITICAL equality -- one person, one vote, one value -- cannot long survive amid deep SOCIAL and ECONOMIC inequality; the Republic must add fraternity and dignity to liberty and equality or the contradiction will endanger the democracy itself. Evidence unit F14: Articles 25-28 secure freedom of conscience and religion subject to public order, morality and health -- a dated constitutional fact showing how India institutionalises plural cohesion, not a proof of any philosophical thesis, and characterising no government or period.

Verdict. Liberal democracy means constitutionally limited popular rule; it does require deeper cohesive principles -- fraternity, dignity and substantive equality -- to balance its individualism, and the Indian constitutional experience states that requirement more sharply than most.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it DEFINES liberal democracy exactly (popular rule + constitutional limits + minority protection), answers the "deeper principles" half with Ambedkar's political-vs-social-equality thesis, and anchors India with F14 (Arts 25-28) as a dated fact, not proof.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: Do you subscribe to the view that Indian cultural identity needs to integrate the principles of multi-culturalism and respect for the dignity of each person? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. I subscribe -- but only if "multiculturalism" means the NORMATIVE principle of recognition and accommodation (not a mere census of diversity) and if "dignity of each person" supplies the internal limit that keeps recognition from sheltering domination. The two principles are complementary precisely because dignity disciplines recognition.

- **Doctrine.** Multiculturalism is both the fact of cultural diversity and the normative claim that a just polity may need public recognition or group- differentiated rights so minorities enjoy equal membership (H6, Taylor: identity is dialogically formed, misrecognition is a real injury). Dignity is humanism's claim that each person has worth independent of birth or rank (H1). India is descriptively plural in language and religion; Articles 29-30 illustrate external protections of cultural and educational interests -- a dated legal fact, not proof.

- **Why they must go together (objection -> reply).** Objection: integrating group recognition risks essentialism and internal restriction, letting community elites dominate members. Reply: the dignity of EACH person is exactly the check -- external protections are justified, internal restrictions are not (H7); recognition owed to a community is not endorsement of its treatment of its own members.

Verdict. Subscribe, conditionally: Indian cultural identity should integrate recognition BECAUSE respect for each person's dignity both motivates recognition and sets its limit.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers "do you subscribe?" with a graded yes, pairs H6 (recognition) with H1/H7 (dignity as the internal-restriction limit), and closes on complementarity rather than praise.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Forms of Government.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: How far do the liberal democracies safeguard the interests of minorities? Evaluate critically.

Model solution

Thesis. Liberal democracy is **NORMATIVELY** committed to minority protection but only **CONDITIONALLY** successful in practice: it safeguards minorities as far as constitutional culture, social equality and institutional independence are real, and no further.

- **The commitment.** Liberal democracy combines popular rule with constitutional limits, rights, rule of law and protection for minorities; its ideal is majority government **WITHOUT** converting number into unrestricted power. Citizenship requires equal moral standing, not merely counting heads.
- **Achievements.** Legal guarantees, representation, judicial review and civil liberties; protection of dissent, association and expression; the possibility of constitutional accommodation of language, religion and culture.
- **Limits (the critical half).** Social prejudice can outlast formal equality; electoral incentives can reward majoritarian rhetoric; minorities may be tolerated formally yet excluded substantively. Evidence unit F10: elections, courts, press and opposition can persist while fairness of contest, limits on majorities and realistic alternation are hollowed out -- a diagnostic grid this answer applies to no actual country, party or period.

Verdict (form/substance). Liberal democracy retains the democratic **FORM** and a genuine normative commitment to minorities; how far it protects them depends on whether the **SUBSTANTIVE** conditions -- independent adjudication, plural media, a rights-respecting culture -- survive. The commitment is real; the safeguard is contingent.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it runs the achievements/limits balance the stem demands, deploys F10 form-vs-substance as the critical engine, and grades with the form/substance verdict instead of a flat "yes/no".

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Development and Social Progress.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.

Model solution

Directive: *State and examine* - first expound the Gandhian concept faithfully, then weigh it with objections and replies and a reasoned verdict.

State - the Gandhian concept of social development. For Gandhi, development is the moral growth of persons and communities, not the volume of production. Its hub is **sarvodaya** - the welfare of all, tested by the condition of the *last and weakest* person. Its supporting commitments are **swaraj** (self-rule as both political freedom and moral self-mastery over wants), **trusteeship** (surplus wealth held in trust for society, not as absolute private right), **restraint of wants** ("enough for need, not for greed"), **dignity of labour** (manual work honoured), and a **decentralised, village-centred** economy using **appropriate technology** scaled to human need. Underlying all is **means-ends unity**: a good end cannot be reached by exploitative means.

Examine - strengths. The model is a powerful critique of consumerist, centralised development: it anticipates **ecological limits** (restraint of throughput), defends **dignity and non-exploitation** as internal to development, and treats people as **moral agents**, not consumers - close, in effect, to a capability-and-sufficiency ethic.

Examine - objections and replies.

- **Scale/romanticisation:** a low-throughput village model may not meet the needs of a large, poor population. *Reply:* the target is insatiable consumerism and centralisation, not health and schooling; "appropriate" scale is revisable without surrendering restraint.
- **Productivity:** restraint may cap the surplus needed to lift millions. *Reply:* the model reframes the *goal* (sufficiency + dignity) rather than maximising output; it is a critique of the metric, not a vow of poverty.

- *Caste and gender (Ambedkar)*: idealising the village can **reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour**. This is the decisive internal-Indian criticism, and it is not fully answered within the Gandhian frame.

Graded verdict. Gandhian social development is a **profound critique of output-centred, centralised modernisation and a partial positive model** - ecologically and morally ahead of its rivals - but it must be **corrected by Ambedkar on caste and gender** and made honest about scale. Its enduring contribution is the metric: development measured by dignity, restraint and the condition of the last person.

Why this earns marks: it "states" the concept completely (all five commitments + means-ends unity), "examines" with a genuine objection/reply set, concedes the Ambedkar critique honestly, and delivers a balanced, non-hagiographic verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar.

PYQ 5 - 2023 · Q3(b) (15 marks)

Question: Critically analyse the social and political significance of Ambedkar's notion of annihilation of caste.

Thesis / opening: Annihilation is socially significant because it makes fraternity and association possible, and politically significant because it makes representation and equal citizenship real.

Model answer structure:

- Trace caste sanction, endogamy and graded inequality.
- Explain why reform of untouchability alone leaves the foundation intact.
- Social significance: free association, inter-caste kinship and fraternity.
- Political significance: autonomous organisation, rights, representation and social democracy.
- Raise legalism/state-competence limits and reply through the wider programme.

Conclusion: The doctrine seeks abolition of hereditary valuation, not merely adjustment of access to offices.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2024 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the role of ethical principles of tolerance and coexistence for the rise of multicultural societies.

Model solution

Thesis. Tolerance and coexistence are NECESSARY ethical conditions for multicultural societies but not SUFFICIENT: a mature multicultural order must climb from tolerance, through coexistence, to RECOGNITION of equal standing.

- **The ladder (the mark-bearing structure).** TOLERANCE restrains coercion against what one disapproves -- indispensable, but potentially HIERARCHICAL, since the powerful "permit" the weak. COEXISTENCE is peaceful shared life. RECOGNITION affirms equal standing and may require institutional accommodation (H6). The rise of a multicultural society is the movement from permission to equal citizenship and reciprocal recognition.

- **Why tolerance and coexistence enable the rise.** Without tolerance, difference invites coercion; without coexistence, plural communities cannot share institutions; these ethical principles make space for the deeper claim that difference deserves not just permission but equal standing.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: tolerance is enough -- recognition over-politicises identity. Reply: tolerance leaves a hierarchy of the tolerating and the tolerated intact, so it secures peace but not equal citizenship; recognition completes what tolerance begins, while remaining revisable and compatible with exit and dissent.

Verdict. Tolerance and coexistence are the ethical preconditions for multicultural societies, but their telos is recognition: a society that merely tolerates has kept the peace without granting equal standing.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it walks the tolerance->coexistence->recognition ladder, shows tolerance is necessary-but-hierarchical, and gives recognition as the completing move.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish common good from public interest and common interest. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The three expressions operate at different levels. **Common good** is the widest normative standard: the justified welfare of the whole political community beyond factional, state or numerical advantage.

Core analysis: **Common interest** is narrower and empirical - an overlap among affected persons. **Public interest** is an authoritative policy judgment claiming to answer a collective need. A labour-management settlement may express both parties' common interest yet fail the common-good test if consumers bear hidden costs; a justified quarantine may be defended in the public interest and also serve common good.

Critical evaluation: The distinction prevents state convenience or coalition strength from becoming self-certifying moral authority.

Conclusion: The safest verdict is tripartite: common good is the widest normative standard, common interest is a narrower empirical overlap, and public interest is the authoritative policy judgment that must remain answerable to the common good.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is community not identical to majority? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: A majority is a numerical relation; community in common-good reasoning is a normative whole. Gauba therefore rejects equating the common good with the preference of the largest electoral or cultural bloc.

Core analysis: The common good may require protecting a minority against majority injustice. Consensus also means continuing accommodation, not the elimination of disagreement. When a dominant religious, caste or linguistic group presents its own way of life as the voice of everyone, sectional interest is merely disguised as community.

Critical evaluation: Community-language is defensible only when dissenters and weaker groups retain rights, equal citizenship, voice and review. Constitutional morality is a supplementary safeguard against majoritarian absorption.

Conclusion: Community is therefore a normative whole, not a head-count winner; once majority will is treated as self-justifying, common good collapses into domination of minorities and dissenters.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare liberal and communitarian conceptions of common good. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Liberalism begins from persons with claims and freedoms; communitarianism begins from socially constituted persons whose goods are shaped by membership and shared purposes.

Core analysis: For liberals, common good emerges through reconciliation under civil rules. Rights protect plurality and prevent mutual oppression. Gauba's Macpherson bridge and welfare correction nevertheless show that market demand may undervalue socially necessary capacities. Communitarians reply that the liberal self is too thin: MacIntyre stresses practices and virtues, Taylor dialogical recognition, and Walzer sphere-specific social meanings rather than one distributive metric.

Further development: The comparison also turns on how each side handles plurality. Liberalism treats disagreement as normal and therefore makes rights, procedures and protected dissent foundational. Communitarianism asks whether such procedures can survive without prior social trust, shared meanings and civic attachment. The sharper conclusion is not that one side refutes the other, but that a workable common-good theory needs both social embeddedness and institutional safeguards against coercive homogeneity.

Critical evaluation: Liberalism can protect rights while thinning solidarity; communitarianism can deepen belonging while risking conformity and dominant-group morality. A defensible common good therefore combines social embeddedness with protected dissent and institutional review.

Conclusion: Liberalism protects plurality by reconciling claims under rights, while communitarianism protects solidarity by locating the self within shared purposes; the stronger answer uses each to correct the other's weakness.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Gandhian sarvodaya as a theory of common good. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Sarvodaya makes common good a moral-civilisational ideal: uplift of all, especially the neglected, through non-violence, labour and restraint rather than aggregate advantage.

Core analysis: Trusteeship treats surplus wealth as a social trust, bread labour joins consumption to dignified physical work, and ahimsa requires unity of means and ends. Gandhi thus rejects both capitalist greed and violent levelling; minority suffering cannot be cancelled by a larger total of benefit.

Further development: A further Indian qualification comes from the owner's own objection-reply architecture and verified cross-routes to Gandhi-Ambedkar material. If harmony is invoked without naming caste, social humiliation and structural exclusion, sarvodaya risks sounding like moral reconciliation without equal standing. The answer should therefore distinguish Gandhi's ethical insight from any complacent assumption that voluntary virtue alone can dissolve entrenched hierarchy.

Critical evaluation: Its strength is ethical depth and anti-exclusion. Its weakness is implementation: trusteeship and renunciation rely heavily on voluntary change, while harmony-language may understate caste and gender hierarchy. Sarvodaya therefore needs enforceable equality, rights and accountable institutions.

Conclusion: Sarvodaya is most defensible as a moral critique of greed, violence and exclusion, but it remains politically adequate only when voluntary ethical transformation is joined to rights, equality and safeguards against hierarchy.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Can common-good reasoning be defended in a plural society without sacrificing minority rights? Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Common-good reasoning can be defended in a plural society, but only in a qualified form. The first step is to reject three false equations already ruled out by the owner: common good is not state good, not majority good and not utilitarian aggregate gain.

Core analysis: Once those errors are removed, the concept can do valuable work. It asks whether citizens can justify shared objectives beyond factional bargaining, while still keeping disagreement legitimate. Liberalism contributes the rights-framework: minorities, dissenters and weaker groups cannot be sacrificed simply because a larger bloc claims to represent the whole. Communitarianism contributes the reminder that citizens are not detached atoms and that common institutions, practices and social trust matter. The supplementary bridges extend this carefully: civic republicanism adds non-domination and active citizenship, commons-thinking adds the need for institutions that prevent both private enclosure and unaccountable state control, and constitutional morality disciplines inherited social consensus when caste, gender or religious hierarchy masquerades as community good.

Further development: This is where the supplementary bridges are most useful. Civic republican non-domination tests whether any citizen or group is left under unchecked discretionary power; commons-thinking tests whether shared resources are governed rather than enclosed; social-capital language explains why cooperation matters but also why exclusionary networks are dangerous; and constitutional morality sets the outer limit by refusing to let inherited consensus override equal citizenship. These additions strengthen rather than replace the chapter's anti-majoritarian core.

Critical evaluation: The strongest objection is internal domination: group-rights or community-language may empower elites within communities and silence women, dissenters or lower-status members. The reply is explicit in the owner's objection-reply chains: voice, exit, equal status, review and public justification remain non-negotiable tests. Common good survives in plural society only as a rights-bounded, contestable and revisable standard.

Conclusion: Yes, but only if common good is defined against state good, majority good and utilitarian expendability, and is disciplined by equal citizenship, dissent, review and constitutional morality.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Compare Marxian, Gandhian and Aristotelian approaches to the common good. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Aristotle, Marx and Gandhi all reject the idea that politics is merely the registration of private appetite, yet they reach the common good through very different routes. Aristotle is constitutional and teleological, Marx structural and conflictual, Gandhi moral and civilisational.

Core analysis: For Aristotle, the right constitution serves the good life of the whole community; the political order is judged by whether it advances the advantage of the whole rather than one class. Marx begins elsewhere. In a class-divided society, he denies that a genuine common good is available at all, because antagonistic ownership structures organise power and interest. Common good becomes fully meaningful only in communist association after class domination is overcome. Gandhi again shifts the ground. He seeks common good through trusteeship, bread labour, non-possession, non-violence and sarvodaya, so that moral self-restraint replaces both capitalist greed and violent levelling. On property and conflict, then, Aristotle seeks right ordering, Marx seeks abolition of class antagonism, and Gandhi seeks ethical transformation.

Further development: Aquinas and Hegel should appear only as bounded comparative bridges, not as direct Gauba Ch.21 evidence. Aquinas extends the flourishing genealogy; Hegel shows freedom mediated through ethical institutions. Both clarify, without replacing, Aristotle's civic whole, Marx's structural critique and Gandhi's moral commonwealth.

Critical evaluation: Their strengths and weaknesses differ correspondingly. Aristotle offers a strong whole-community criterion but can underplay entrenched exclusion. Marx best diagnoses structural barriers yet faces the owner's realisation problem: new domination may follow abolition of private class power. Gandhi provides the richest moral critique but depends heavily on voluntarism. A high-quality comparison preserves these distinct problem-settings instead of turning all three into vague theories of welfare.

Conclusion: All three reject narrow private self-interest, yet Aristotle locates common good in right constitutional order, Marx in overcoming class domination, and Gandhi in moral self-restraint and sarvodaya; no serious comparison should flatten these distinct routes into one doctrine.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.